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# Lead Software Engineer (ServiceNow)

Department for Work and Pensions

**Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 8th November 2026**

Department for Work & Pensions

**Reference number**

483218

**Salary**

£75,026 - £92,522

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

**Job grade**

Grade 6

**Contract type**

Permanent

**Business area**

DWP - Digital

**Type of role**

Digital
Engineering
Information Technology

**Working pattern**

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

**Number of jobs available**

1

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## Location

This role may be located in one of the following locations; Birmingham, Blackpool, Leeds, Manchester, Newcastle Upon Tyne and Sheffield.

Please find further information on the Corporate hub locations here.

Please note: for candidates requesting to work in Newcastle, the role will initially be based at Benton Park View. It will then move to 1 Pilgrim Place in

Newcastle city centre by the end of 2027.

For candidates requesting to work in Sheffield King  s Court, please note these roles will initially be based at King  s Court and then move to 1 West Bar by early 2028

## About the job

**Job summary**

**Are you capable of leading & mentoring engineering teams while helping to shape and deliver services? Are you an experienced ServiceNow Software Engineer looking to take the next step in your career?**

You will lead a team within Department for Work and pensions (DWP) working on one of the largest government installations of ServiceNow within Europe.

You will be responsible for ensuring that application development meets standards and requirements within ServiceNow across multiple modules, acting as an initial point of contact for technical guidance within the Corporate Centre Services Federated Team. The platform currently supports circa 120,000 colleagues across the multiple ServiceNow modules and applications, exposing us regularly to a wide range of different challenges and opportunities within the ServiceNow ecosphere.

The successful candidate will join DWP Digital and be an integral part in directing and determining how we build the technology solutions of the future that will enable us to realise our key mission and passion.

What really excites the successful candidate is problem-solving and the opportunity to deliver innovative technology that carries real value for users.

If this sounds like you, apply today!

**Please note:** Holding a **ServiceNow Certified System Administrator** qualification is a mandatory requirement for this role. Evidence of the qualification will be required at interview stage.

## Job description

Our Lead Software Engineers are experts in their field, role models in software craftsmanship and have proven experience in the design, development and support of software products.

You will:

- Define standards for the Engineering community and lead their adoption across teams to deliver quality software products.
- Be an enabler for multiple teams, driving consistency, standards, pace and quality, resolving technical blockers and promoting re-use and collaboration through the wider community.
- Influence our future vision for delivery as part of the Leadership Team and then take ownership for bringing the engineering community on that journey.
- Have an excellent ability to self-organise and define priorities.
- Be capable of diving in where necessary, but the focus of this role will be to lead and set direction for multiple engineering teams effectively and successfully.

## Person specification

See selection process for further details.

If you would like to learn more about the role, please contact Aisha.Gultasab@dwp.gov.uk.

## Qualifications

ServiceNow Certified System Administrator

## Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

- Programming and Build

# Benefits

Alongside your salary of £75,026, Department for Work and Pensions contributes £21,735 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

We also have a broad benefits package built around your work-life balance which includes:

- Working patterns to support work/life balance such as job sharing, term-time working, flexi-time and compressed hours.
- Generous annual leave at least 25 days on entry, increasing up to 30 days over time (pro rata for part time employees), plus 9 days public and privilege leave.
- Support for financial wellbeing, including interest-free season ticket loans for travel, a cycle to work scheme and an employee discount scheme.
- Health and wellbeing support including our Employee Assistance Programme for specialist advice and counselling and the opportunity to join HASSRA a first-class programme of competitions, activities and benefits for its members (subscription payable monthly).
- Family friendly policies including enhanced maternity and shared parental leave pay after 1 year s continuous service.
- Funded learning and development to support progress in your role and career. This includes industry recognised qualifications and accreditations, coaching, mentoring and talent development programmes.
- An inclusive and diverse environment with opportunities to join professional and interpersonal networks including Women s Network, National Race Network, National Disability Network (THRIVE) and many more.

**Hybrid Working**

This role may be suitable for hybrid working, which is where an employee works part of the week in their DWP office and part of the week from home.

This is a voluntary, non-contractual arrangement and your office will be your contractual place of work.

If a hybrid working arrangement is suitable for the role and for you, you will normally be required to spend a minimum of 60% of your contracted working hours from your DWP office.

If you have a disability, caring responsibilities, or other circumstances that may affect your ability to meet the minimum office attendance requirement, please discuss this with us using the contact details in this advert.

**Salary Information**

Pay for this role is from £75,026 to £92,522.

The maximum salary for the grade is £80,267, however a Digital Allowance of up to £12,255 per annum is available for exceptional candidates. Digital Allowance is non-salary, and non-pensionable, and is classed as a temporary allowance. It is reviewed annually where it could be retained, amended, or removed.

Our offer to successful candidates will be based on an assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated at interview.

Existing Civil Servants who secure a new role on lateral transfer will maintain their current substantive salary.

Civil Servants who gain promotion will move to the bottom of the grade pay scale or receive a 10% increase applied to their current substantive salary, whichever is greater.

Any temporary allowances that you are currently in receipt of will not form part of the calculation to determine your pay. Any allowances that are in payment will cease when you move into your new role.

# Things you need to know

**Artificial intelligence**

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

**Selection process details**

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Experience and Technical skills.

**Stage 1: Application**

Your application will consist of four parts:

1. A Personal Details application form.

2. Employment history - this should contain your work experience and any skills, qualifications and accomplishments relevant to the jobs you have completed.

3. Personal statement - up to 1250 words. This statement should be used to provide examples of how you meet the essential criteria below:

Demonstrable commercial experience of various modules and applications within ServiceNow (E.G ITSM, ITOM, SPM, Security, HRSD, Service Portals, Workspaces, CMDB, Integrations)

Strong working knowledge with a deep understanding of each layer of an organisation s cyber security controls, designing solutions that enable defence in depth and services with security controls embedded, and/or strong working knowledge with a deep understanding of each layer of an organisation s IT operations controls, designing solutions that enable automation of IT and through AI operations.

Significant demonstrable experience of implementing ServiceNow Security Operations or IT operations modules.

Influential and able to lead investigative work into problems and opportunities in existing processes, driving the collection of information and creation of recommendations for improvements. Can absorb large amounts of conflicting information and use it to determine solutions.

Extensive experience and proven track record in designing, implementing, administering and supporting Security products and services, ensuring adherence to Digital Security Standards and Architectural Principles both on premise and in Cloud.

4. Technical statement (up to 250 words). The following statement is aligned to the required technical skill of: Programming and Build. This statement should be used to provide example(s) of how you meet the criterion below:

Demonstrable expertise in developing, maintaining and enhancing the ServiceNow platform, including application development, workflow automation, system integration and platform upgrades.

Ensure that all examples provided in your statements are taken directly from your own experience and that you describe the examples in your own words. If you choose to use gen-AI to support your statements, you must follow the guidelines outlined in the **Artificial intelligence and recruitment guide.**

The sift panel will use the information in your employment history, personal statement, and technical statement to assess your experience, skills and knowledge.

An initial sift will be conducted using the technical statement. Candidates who pass the initial sift will be progressed to a full sift.

If you do progress to a full sift, you will be provided with one combined overall assessment score for both your employment history and Personal Statement.

For Hints and Tips on completing your application visit Applying for jobs at DWP Digital.

**Important Information**

You will be asked to complete your employment history. Any information that you would customarily share on a CV should therefore be entered onto the application form.

Personal details that could be used to identify you including your name, contact details and address must be removed for your application to be considered.

**If your employment history, personal statement or technical statement contain any personal details your application will be withdrawn.**

**Stage 2: Interview**

If you re successful at the sift stage, you ll be invited to a video interview via Microsoft Teams. During the interview, you ll be assessed against the experience criteria listed under both the essential criteria and technical skill.

You will also be asked to do a 10 minute presentation on the topic below.

Your experience of implementation of new or enhanced ServiceNow functionality within a large organisation. We are interested in the business need, your contribution, stakeholder engagement and the value and measurable benefits delivered.

Interviews will take place from late November 2026. Interview dates to be confirmed.

**Please note:** Holding a ServiceNow Certified System Administrator qualification is a mandatory requirement for this role. Evidence of the qualification will be required at interview stage.

**Other information:**

If high application volumes are received, the benchmark for candidates to proceed to the next stage may be raised. In line with our commitment to the Disability Confident Scheme (DCS), we aim to advance all candidates applying under the DCS who meet the minimum standard. However, we may only progress those candidates who best meet the required standards.

All successful candidates and those placed on reserve will be posted in merit list order by location.

Please note that for these vacancies we recommend that applicants seek specialist advice on their eligibility for Visa Sponsorship (if applicable) when considering whether to apply for any role. We can never guarantee sponsorship, requests will be considered in line with the relevant DWP guidance and Home Office policy in place at the time.

**Further Information**

At the Department for Work and Pensions (DWP) we value diversity and inclusion and actively encourage and welcome applications from everyone, including those that are underrepresented in our workforce.

Find out more about working for DWP on the DWP Careers Hub.

**Reserve List**

A reserve list may be held for a period of 6 months from which further appointments can be made.

If you are placed on a reserve list but we cannot immediately offer you a post, please note:

- If you are later offered the role you applied for, in a location you have expressed a preference for, and you decline the offer or are unable to take up the post within a reasonable timeframe you will be withdrawn from the campaign and removed from the reserve list, other than in exceptional circumstances (e.g. a contractual Part Time Working Pattern cannot be accommodated in the initial role offered or in cases of serious ill health).
- If DWP makes an offer of an alternative role or location to that which you originally applied for, and you decline that offer, you will be able to remain on the reserve list.

**Disability Confident Scheme**

If high application volumes are received, the benchmark for candidates to proceed to the next stage may be raised. In line with our commitment to the Disability Confident Scheme (DCS), we aim to advance all candidates

applying under the DCS who meet the minimum standard. However, we may only progress those candidates who best meet the required standards.

**Reasonable Adjustments**

We consider visible and non-visible disabilities, neurodiversity or learning differences, chronic medical conditions, or mental ill health. Examples include dyslexia, epilepsy, autism, chronic fatigue, or schizophrenia.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should contact the Government Recruitment Service via DWPRecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Reasonable Adjustments section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you re deaf, a Language Service Professional.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

**Integrity, plagiarism and Civil Service Principles**

The Civil Service values honesty and integrity and expects all candidates to abide by these principles.

Please ensure that all examples provided in your application are taken directly from your own experience and that you describe the examples in your own words.

Examples of plagiarism can include:

- Presenting the work, ideas and experience of others as your own

- Copying content or answers from an online or published source that is not your own

**Disclosure and Barring Service and Internal Fraud Database Checks**

To process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service on your behalf. However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant s details held on the IFD will be refused employment. A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

If successful and transferring from another Government Department, a criminal record check will be carried out.

**Important**

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Before applying for this vacancy, current employees of DWP should check whether a successful application would result in changes to their terms & conditions of employment, e.g. mobility, pay, allowances. If you are a current employee and are successful you must be able to be released from your current post within four weeks.

Those on protected TUPE/ COSoP terms and conditions applying on promotion or voluntary permanent level move will adopt DWP s Terms and Conditions and this may have a different impact on pay and allowances. Please review this prior to acceptance of a role.

Civil Servants that would transfer into DWP from other government organisations, following successful application, will assume DWP's terms &

conditions of employment current on the day they are posted, unless DWP has stated otherwise in writing. Accepting a post will be taken to mean acceptance of revised terms & conditions.

Civil Servants applying on promotion will usually be appointed to the salary minimum or within 10% of existing salary.

Any move to DWP from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may, however, be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at the Childcare Choices Website.

For further information on reasonable adjustments, terms and conditions and how we recruit visit the How we recruit page.

**Feedback**

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

**Security**

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

**Nationality requirements**

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

**Working for the Civil Service**

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

**Diversity and Inclusion**

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

## Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

**Contact point for applicants**

Job contact :

Name : Aisha Gultasab

Email : Aisha.Gultasab@dwp.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : digitialrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Civil Service Commission

disability confident LEADER